

Catalyst Learner Pathway Alignment Tool

Consolidated Build Packet

Framework version: 0.3_draft

Module 1 scoring version: 0.2_draft

This packet compiles the confirmed structure, items, scenarios, scoring rules, and report language for the assessment. It supersedes the four-module framing. The tool is now a three-module scored assessment, a universal design practice layer, and a program-level alignment layer. It is a structured self-report and pathway alignment tool intended to support reflection, coaching, learner confidence, and pathway alignment. It is not a validated clinical, psychological, learning-style matching, or employment selection instrument and should not be described as one.

What changed in version 0.3: result language for Modules 2 and 3 was drafted and added, learner-facing and facilitator-facing, completing the prewritten-block set across all three modules; the transition messages were finalized to the three-module flow.

What changed in version 0.2: Module 1 items were rewritten for stronger discrimination among the people-facing archetypes; Module 2 expanded from eight to twelve scenarios; Module 3 expanded risk comfort from two to four items including one reverse-scored item; Module 4 was retired as an assessment module and moved into universal design facilitation practice; archetype definitions and learner and facilitator language were drafted.

Part 1: Architecture and intake

Module structure

Three scored assessment modules, one universal design practice layer, and one program and partner track alignment layer.

1. Module 1: Archetype identity. Who is this learner across contexts.
2. Module 2: Work style scenarios. How they are most likely to respond in realistic tech-related situations.
3. Module 3: Motivation and pathway orientation. What keeps them engaged, and whether they lean toward placement, ownership, or a blend.
4. Universal design practice layer: varied resources and structured peer exchange for every learner. Not a scored assessment module.
5. Alignment layer: program and partner training track matches. Not an assessment module.

Intake order and flow

Learners experience the scored modules in numerical order: Module 1, then Module 2, then Module 3. Single full required intake. Learners complete all three scored modules before receiving results. Present Module 1 in two visual sections, roughly items 1 to 14 and 15 to 27, while scoring it as one module. No unscored warm-up question before Module 1. No module-level results shown during intake.

Target total: 49 items. Module 1 at 27, Module 2 at 12 scenarios, Module 3 at 10. Completion window roughly 10 to 15 minutes. Do not exceed 60 items.

Transition messages

Moment	Message
Mid Module 1	That's the first half of Module 1. The next set is loading now.
After Module 1	That's Module 1. Module 2 is loading now. The format shifts to short scenarios.
After Module 2	That's Module 2. Module 3 is loading now. It's the last one, and the shortest.
After Module 3, loading profile	That's all three modules. Your profile is loading now.

Results release

Release the reflection profile immediately. Review placement decisions before finalizing.

1. Learner completes all three scored modules in one intake.
2. Learner immediately sees their combined profile: archetype, work style, motivation and pathway orientation, plus strengths-based next-step framing.
3. Facilitator receives a completion notification and access to the facilitator-facing report.
4. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors follow up for a coaching conversation within 5 to 7 business days.
5. For Catalyst or other high-stakes placement, the system may generate a placement recommendation but must not auto-assign.
6. Placement and resource decisions are confirmed by a facilitator after the coaching conversation.

If a learner completes the intake outside facilitator working hours, release the profile immediately. Coaching outreach can happen the next business day. The profile does not wait for facilitator availability.

Report architecture

Hybrid. Each scored module produces its own output at the data layer. Learners receive one combined profile after completing all three scored modules. Facilitators receive the combined profile plus module-level drill-downs.

The combined report must not produce a single composite score across modules, predict job success or training outcomes, collapse the learner into one type, or drop a wall of text. Use

progressive disclosure: a short summary at the top with expandable sections per dimension, and facilitator drill-down behind the combined profile.

Build the modules first and validate them through pilot. Build the combined report synthesis layer last, after the modules are stable.

Part 2: Scoring and reporting rules

These rules apply across all scored modules.

Score calculation

Use averages as the primary computational field. Store raw totals internally. Optional percentages may appear in facilitator-facing reports only. Do not show percentages to learners. Do not use normalized scores until at least 100 to 200 completed assessments are available.

Scales

Modules 1 and 3 use the same 5-point Likert scale, averaged to a 1.00 to 5.00 dimension score.

Response	Score
Strongly disagree	1
Disagree	2
Not sure / Sometimes	3
Agree	4
Strongly agree	5

Module 2 uses forced-choice scoring. Report axis positions rather than high or low scores. Preserve whether each axis result is a 3-to-0 clear lean or a 2-to-1 lighter lean in the data layer. Do not convert Module 2 into a numeric display range that implies false precision.

Learner-facing output

Learners see labels and narrative only. No raw totals, average scores, percentages, or technical confidence labels. A simple non-numeric relative-strength visual is acceptable if it supports reflection without implying false precision. Language must be strengths-first, confidence-building, and developmental.

Facilitator-facing output

Facilitators see more detail: full score tables, confidence bands, blended and broad-high and flat and low-confidence and tie flags, coaching questions, cross-module observations, and program alignment notes.

Uncertainty and confidence language

Keep uncertainty flags in the facilitator view. Do not show learners phrases such as "needs reflection," "facilitator review recommended," or "low-confidence result." Use developmental learner-facing language instead. Sample blocks:

- "Your strengths are still taking shape. This is normal, especially when you are exploring new environments. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors will help you build on what is already showing up."
- "Your responses show strengths across many areas. This often means you adapt to different situations or bring range. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors will help you identify where to focus first."
- "Your pattern is showing range across several strengths. This is a starting point for a coaching conversation, not a final picture."

Narrative report generation

Use prewritten language blocks for pilot. Do not use fully automatic narrative generation during pilot. Consider automatic generation only after pilot data validates the language, and begin only with the combined synthesis layer. Keep dimension-level descriptions prewritten until there is strong evidence that generated language is safe and accurate.

Pathway recommendation logic

Pathway recommendations use Modules 1, 2, and 3 together. No single module drives placement. Catalyst placement recommendations are reviewed and confirmed by a facilitator before final placement.

Part 3: Module 1, Archetype Identity

What it measures

Module 1 identifies the learner's primary identity-oriented archetype across nine archetypes, three items each, twenty-seven items total.

The nine archetypes and the boundary map

1. Navigator: direction, purpose, where things are headed.
2. Developer: building, making real, fixing.
3. Igniter: starting, momentum, initiative.
4. Connector: bridging separate people, ideas, and resources.
5. Systems Thinker: patterns, causes, structure.
6. Culture Keeper: the group's emotional climate, belonging, mood.
7. Designer: the artifact or experience, usability, how a thing looks and feels and works for the user.

8. Support Specialist: one-on-one helping, troubleshooting, steadying an individual.

9. Explorer: curiosity, experimentation, multiple paths.

The four that blur are Connector, Support Specialist, Culture Keeper, and Designer. Each owns one thing, and the items use language only that archetype would use.

- Connector owns the bridge between separate people, ideas, or resources. Many to many linking.
- Support Specialist owns one person getting unstuck. One to one troubleshooting and explaining.
- Culture Keeper owns the group's emotional climate. Mood, belonging, the collective.
- Designer owns the artifact or experience itself. How a thing looks, feels, and works for whoever uses it.

The boundaries that must hold: linking many versus helping one, the group's mood versus the individual's problem, functional linking versus emotional climate, and shaping the thing versus explaining to people.

The 27 items

Navigator

- M1-NAV-01: I like understanding the bigger purpose before I start working on something.
- M1-NAV-02: I often think about where a project or idea is headed.
- M1-NAV-03: I often think about what the goal is and what step comes next, even when working on my own.

Developer

- M1-DEV-01: I like turning ideas into something real that people can use, test, or improve.
- M1-DEV-02: I enjoy hands-on tasks where I can build, fix, or figure something out.
- M1-DEV-03: I feel motivated when I can see something I am building or fixing come together.

Igniter

- M1-IGN-01: When something needs to get started, I am usually willing to take the first step.
- M1-IGN-02: I like helping ideas move from talking into action.
- M1-IGN-03: I am willing to get started even when the plan is not fully figured out yet.

Connector

- M1-CON-01: I often notice when people, ideas, or resources need to be connected.
- M1-CON-02: When I see two people or ideas that should connect, I often help make that link happen.
- M1-CON-03: When two people are talking past each other, I often step in to help them understand each other.

Systems Thinker

- M1-SYS-01: I often look for the patterns or causes behind a problem.
- M1-SYS-02: I like figuring out how the different parts of something fit together.
- M1-SYS-03: Before choosing a solution, I often want to understand what is really causing the issue.

Culture Keeper

- M1-CUL-01: I notice when the mood or energy in a group changes.
- M1-CUL-02: I often do small things to help people feel included.
- M1-CUL-03: When a group feels tense, I often try to help things feel calmer.

Designer

- M1-DES-01: I like making things easier and more pleasant to use.
- M1-DES-02: I notice when something feels confusing, hard to use, or poorly organized.
- M1-DES-03: I enjoy shaping how something looks, feels, sounds, or works for the person using it.

Support Specialist

- M1-SUP-01: I usually stay patient when I am helping someone work through a problem.
- M1-SUP-02: I like helping people feel less stuck, confused, or overwhelmed.
- M1-SUP-03: When I explain something, I often break it into small steps so it is easier to follow.

Explorer

- M1-EXP-01: I like trying different options before deciding what direction fits me best.
- M1-EXP-02: I learn a lot by trying things out and asking questions.
- M1-EXP-03: I am interested in more than one path and like having room to discover what fits.

Scoring formula

1. Raw archetype score = sum of the three item scores for that archetype.
2. Average archetype score = raw score divided by 3.
3. Optional percentage for facilitator display = ((average minus 1) divided by 4) times 100.
4. Primary archetype = highest average score.
5. Secondary archetype = second-highest average, reported only if primary average minus secondary average is 0.50 or less.
6. Blended profile = produced when primary average minus secondary average is 0.25 or less.

Use average score rather than raw score as the primary comparison field.

Confidence bands

Result type	Rule	Output
High-confidence primary	Primary average at or above 4.00 and gap from second at or above 0.50	Report primary clearly. Secondary optional for facilitator.
Moderate-confidence primary	Primary average at or above 3.50 and gap from second between 0.26 and 0.49	Report primary, secondary optional.
Blended profile	Gap between first and second at or below 0.25	Report primary plus secondary as blended.
Low-confidence or reflective	Top average below 3.25	Use the developmental "still taking shape" learner language. Recommend facilitator discussion.
Very broad high pattern	Five or more archetypes at or above 4.00	Flag for facilitator. Use the "strengths across many areas" learner language.
Very flat pattern	All averages between 2.75 and 3.50	Flag as exploratory. Recommend coaching conversation.

Tie rules

- Two-way tie for first: output a blended profile using both archetypes.
- Three-way tie: output the top three as strong patterns, set facilitator review to true.
- Four or more tied: do not output all tied archetypes. Output "your pattern is still emerging," set facilitator review to true, use the developmental language. Recommend coaching.

Archetype bank: definitions, learner language, facilitator language

A shared closing line runs under every learner result: "This is a snapshot of how you tend to show up right now. It is a starting point, not a fixed label, and not a limit on what you can become."

Navigator

Definition: Orients toward direction and purpose. Wants to understand where something is headed and why before acting, and keeps the goal in view when others lose it in the details.

Learner-facing: You want to understand the point of something before you dive in. You think about where things are headed, not just what is in front of you, and you tend to hold onto the goal when other people get lost in the details. That sense of direction is genuinely useful. As you grow, the edge is acting before everything is fully clear, because the world rarely hands you the whole map first. Your instinct for purpose is a strong place to build from.

Facilitator: Leads with purpose and direction. Engages best when the why and the destination are clear, and can stall on work that feels pointless. **Strength:** big-picture orientation, keeping the goal in view. **Growth edge:** tolerating ambiguity, starting before the picture is complete.

Cross-module: a Navigator who is also methodical and structured will especially want clarity up front; an adaptive one moves more easily. **Coaching angle:** connect tasks to the larger purpose, and practice taking first steps with incomplete information.

Developer

Definition: Turns ideas into real, working things. Motivated by hands-on building, fixing, and visible progress on something they are making.

Learner-facing: You like making things real. Ideas are fine, but you come alive when you can build, fix, or get your hands on something and watch it work. Seeing something you made come together is what keeps you going. That drive to produce is a real asset, especially in tech, where so much of the work is building. As you grow, the edge is stepping back to ask why and for whom before you build, so your skill goes toward what matters most.

Facilitator: Motivated by tangible output. Thrives with projects and prototypes, loses energy in long abstract discussion. **Strength:** making ideas real, persistence through building. **Growth edge:** pausing to weigh purpose and user before constructing. **Cross-module:** high Module 3 self-direction leans toward building their own thing; high stability-seeking prefers building inside an established team. **Coaching angle:** give them something to make early, tied to a clear purpose so they do not optimize the wrong thing well.

Igniter

Definition: Provides activation energy. Starts things, takes the first step, and moves ideas from talk into action, even before the plan is fully formed.

Learner-facing: You get things moving. When a group is stuck talking, you are the one who actually starts. You are willing to take the first step before everything is figured out, and that momentum is something a lot of people lack. Groups need it. As you grow, the edge is pairing your fast start with follow-through, so the things you kick off also get finished well.

Facilitator: Brings initiative and momentum, comfortable starting before conditions are perfect. **Strength:** activation, bias toward action. **Growth edge:** follow-through past the exciting start. **Cross-module:** keep Igniter (starting) separate from Module 2 pace (speed); an

Igniter can be methodical once underway. High initiative with low Module 3 risk comfort can mean someone who starts boldly but strains under sustained uncertainty. Coaching angle: channel the starting energy, then build structure that supports finishing.

Connector

Definition: Bridges separate people, ideas, and resources. Notices useful links others miss and helps different parties understand each other.

Learner-facing: You see connections other people miss. You notice when two people, or two ideas, should be linked, and you often make that link happen. When people are talking past each other, you are the one who helps them actually understand. That bridging instinct is rare and valuable, in tech and everywhere. As you grow, the edge is protecting time for your own focused work, because connectors can give so much to others that their own projects keep waiting.

Facilitator: Thinks in links and relationships across people, ideas, and resources. A natural bridge and translator. Strength: communication across difference, spotting useful links.

Growth edge: protecting their own focus, not over-extending into everyone's needs. Cross-module: keep Connector (identity) separate from Module 2 social energy (work preference); a Connector can still prefer solo work. Coaching angle: use the bridging in real roles, and watch that they do not become the unpaid glue who never advances their own goals.

Systems Thinker

Definition: Looks for patterns, causes, and structure. Wants to understand how parts fit and what is really driving a problem before choosing a solution.

Learner-facing: You want to understand how things actually work. You look for the patterns and the real causes behind a problem instead of reacting to the surface, and before you pick a solution you want to know what is really going on underneath. That depth is a serious strength, especially in technical work, where the obvious answer is often the wrong one. As you grow, the edge is knowing when you have analyzed enough and it is time to decide and move.

Facilitator: Analyzes structure and causation, strong at root-cause work. Strength: analytical depth, pattern recognition, getting past symptoms. Growth edge: analysis paralysis, knowing when understanding is enough. Cross-module: a Systems Thinker who is also methodical especially needs permission to stop analyzing and decide. Coaching angle: value the depth, give clear decision points so analysis converts to action.

Culture Keeper

Definition: Tends the emotional climate of a group. Notices shifts in mood and energy, helps people feel included, and steadies a group when things get tense.

Learner-facing: You feel the temperature of a room. You notice when the mood in a group shifts, often before anyone says anything, and you do small things to help people feel included and to keep things steady when they get tense. That care for how a group feels is a

real strength, and it is the kind of thing that makes teams actually work. As you grow, the edge is tending to your own needs too, not only everyone else's, so the care you give does not run you empty.

Facilitator: Attends to group climate, belonging, and morale, senses mood shifts early. Strength: emotional awareness, inclusion, group stability. Growth edge: boundaries and self-care, since they often carry the group's emotional load. Cross-module: distinguish Culture Keeper (tending the collective) from Support Specialist (helping an individual) and from Module 2 social energy (preferring group work). Coaching angle: name and value the emotional labor explicitly, help them set boundaries so they do not absorb everyone's stress.

Designer

Definition: Shapes how things look, feel, and work for the person using them. Notices when something is confusing or hard to use and makes it clearer and more pleasant.

Learner-facing: You notice when something is clunky, confusing, or hard to use, and it bothers you in a way it does not bother most people. You like shaping how a thing looks, feels, and works for whoever is on the other end of it. That eye for the experience is a genuine strength, and it is exactly what good design and good technology depend on. As you grow, the edge is balancing making something good with getting it in front of people, because real feedback beats endless polishing.

Facilitator: Focuses on usability and the craft of how a thing works for its user, notices friction and wants to fix it. Strength: user empathy, attention to experience, quality of craft. Growth edge: perfectionism, knowing when good enough is enough to ship and learn. Cross-module: separate Designer (shaping the artifact) from Connector (bridging people) and Developer (building function); a methodical Designer especially tends toward over-polishing. Coaching angle: protect the craft, give deadlines and real users so polishing becomes iteration.

Support Specialist

Definition: Helps a person get unstuck. Patient one-on-one troubleshooting, breaking things into steps, and steadying someone who is struggling.

Learner-facing: You are the person others come to when they are stuck. You stay patient while someone works through something hard, and you have a way of breaking a confusing thing into small steps until it finally makes sense to them. Helping someone go from lost to capable is something you do well, and probably do often. That is a real strength, and it is the heart of a lot of good technical work. As you grow, the edge is pursuing your own learning and goals too, not only helping everyone else reach theirs.

Facilitator: Excels at one-on-one help, troubleshooting, and patient explanation, meeting a struggling person where they are. Strength: patience, breaking down complexity, steadying others. Growth edge: advancing their own goals, avoiding being typecast purely as helper. Cross-module: distinguish Support (helping one person) from Connector (linking many) and Culture Keeper (tending the group). Coaching angle: value the helping, and actively create space for their own advancement so the strength does not cap their growth.

Explorer

Definition: Driven by curiosity and openness. Tries different options, learns by experimenting, and stays interested in more than one path before committing.

Learner-facing: You like to try things before you commit. You learn by experimenting and asking questions, and you are genuinely interested in more than one path, which means you want room to discover what actually fits you. That openness is a strength, especially right now, while you are figuring out where you are headed. As you grow, the edge is committing to something long enough to go deep, because the richest discoveries often come after you stop sampling and stay a while.

Facilitator: Curious, keeps options open, learns through experimentation, resists premature commitment. Strength: adaptability, breadth, willingness to try. Growth edge: committing and going deep rather than staying at the surface across many things. Cross-module: a flat or blended Module 1 result is common and consistent with a genuine Explorer, so do not over-pathologize it; pair with Module 3 to see what they are reaching toward. Coaching angle: honor the exploration phase, help them set a project or time boundary to practice depth without feeling trapped.

Part 4: Module 2, Work Style Scenarios

What it measures

How a learner is most likely to behave in realistic tech-related situations. Forced-choice "most likely" format, which counterbalances Module 1's Likert scale by requiring a single choice rather than agreement with everything. Four bipolar dimensions, three scenarios each, twelve scenarios total.

The four dimensions

1. Social energy: Solo to Collaborative.
2. Structure preference: Structured to Adaptive.
3. Contribution mode: Front-facing to Behind the scenes.
4. Pace: Quick-moving to Methodical.

All four are bipolar. Neither pole is better than the other. The output reports a position on each axis, never a high or low score.

The 12 scenarios

Both options in each pair are written to read as equally legitimate. The A and B pole order is alternated across scenarios so learners cannot pick one letter out of habit.

Social energy

- M2-SOC-01: You're handed a new project to figure out over the next couple of weeks. What's your instinct?
 - A) Dig into it on your own first, then bring people in once you have something. (Solo)
 - B) Pull a few people together early to think it through out loud. (Collaborative)
- M2-SOC-02: You're stuck on a problem. What's your first move?
 - A) Step back and work it out yourself. You usually find it by digging in. (Solo)
 - B) Talk it through with someone. You think better bouncing it off another person. (Collaborative)
- M2-SOC-03: Your team needs to come up with ideas. What gets your best thinking going?
 - A) Brainstorming out loud with the group. (Collaborative)
 - B) Going off to think on your own, then bringing your ideas back. (Solo)

Structure preference

- M2-STR-01: Halfway through a project, the plan changes. What's your natural response?
 - A) Roll with it and adjust as you go. (Adaptive)
 - B) Pause and map out a new clear plan before moving on. (Structured)
- M2-STR-02: You're handed a task you've never done before. What would you rather have?
 - A) Knowing exactly what's expected, so you can get straight to it. (Structured)
 - B) Just the goal, and room to work out your own way to it. (Adaptive)
- M2-STR-03: Which kind of work day actually suits you better?
 - A) One with a clear schedule and a set list to get through. (Structured)
 - B) One where you decide as you go what to work on next. (Adaptive)

Contribution mode

- M2-CON-01: A new project is kicking off. Which part would you rather take on?
 - A) Being the face of it, the one who talks to people and represents the work. (Front-facing)
 - B) Building the parts that make it work, out of the spotlight. (Behind the scenes)
- M2-CON-02: You're asked to demo your work to a room of people. What's your instinct?
 - A) You're happy to be the one up front presenting it. (Front-facing)
 - B) You'd rather have built it and let someone else present. (Behind the scenes)
- M2-CON-03: When a project is running, which role fits you better?
 - A) Being the person heads-down on the work itself. (Behind the scenes)

- B) Being the person others come to with questions, the point of contact. (Front-facing)

Pace

- M2-PAC-01: You've got a task to complete. How do you tend to work?
 - A) Get a rough version done fast, then improve it. (Quick-moving)
 - B) Take your time and get it right the first time. (Methodical)
- M2-PAC-02: You're up against a deadline. What's your default?
 - A) Pick up the pace and keep things moving. You'd rather get it done. (Quick-moving)
 - B) Hold your pace and stay careful. You'd rather get it right. (Methodical)
- M2-PAC-03: You have to make a decision on something. How do you usually go?
 - A) Take your time to weigh it carefully first. (Methodical)
 - B) Make the call quickly and keep moving. (Quick-moving)

Scoring

Each option maps to one pole. A learner's position on each axis is based on which pole they chose across the three scenarios: a 3-to-0 clean sweep or a 2-to-1 lean. Report a position, never a high or low score.

Because each axis now has three forced-choice scenarios, there is no true mathematical tie on an axis. If Catalyst wants to keep a learner-facing "balanced" label, Fonz and the team need an explicit display rule, such as treating a 2-to-1 pattern as "balanced with a lean." Otherwise, the clean implementation is to report the leaned pole and store the strength of signal.

Anti-gatekeeping guardrail

Write this into the Module 2 output logic, not just facilitator notes. A pace or work-style mismatch with a track informs support and coaching, never exclusion. A methodical learner in a fast track is supported with pacing strategies and early check-ins, not steered away. When two or more dimensions oppose a track's profile, flag it as higher sustainability risk for coaching attention, never as a reason to block placement.

Result language

Both poles of every axis read as equally legitimate. Each axis reports the leaned pole and the strength of signal: 3-to-0 clear lean or 2-to-1 lighter lean. The balanced language below is retained only as optional future/display language if the team decides to create a "balanced with a lean" display rule.

Universal learner framing line: *Module 2 looked at how you tend to work in real situations. There are no better or worse answers here, just different ways of getting things done.*

Social energy

Leans Solo (learner): You tend to do your best work with some space to yourself. You like to think things through and make progress on your own before bringing others in. That focus is a real strength, and a lot of deep work needs exactly that. One thing to keep in view as you grow is staying connected enough that you do not miss what other people could add.

Leans Collaborative (learner): You tend to do your best work alongside other people. Talking things through and thinking out loud is where your ideas come alive. That energy is a real strength, and good teams run on it. One thing to keep in view as you grow is carving out some focused solo time too, since some work gets done best in quiet.

Balanced (learner): You move comfortably between working on your own and working with others, depending on what the task needs. That flexibility is genuinely useful, because real work calls for both. As you grow, you can lean on knowing which mode a given task actually calls for.

Facilitator: Reports where the learner does their best work, solo, collaborative, or flexibly between. Not a measure of whether they are social. Coaching angle: match early tasks to their mode where possible, then stretch the other mode gently. A strong solo lean may need deliberate inclusion in group work; a strong collaborative lean may need support building solo focus. Keep separate from Module 1 Connector, which is about seeing links, not preferring company.

Structure preference

Leans Structured (learner): You do your best work when you know what is expected and have a clear plan to follow. Structure is not a crutch for you, it is what lets you move efficiently and well. That is a real strength, especially in work that rewards precision. As you grow, the edge is staying steady when a plan changes, since not every situation hands you the full map up front.

Leans Adaptive (learner): You do your best work with room to figure things out as you go. Open-ended situations that might unsettle others are where you do well. That adaptability is a real strength, especially in work that changes fast. As you grow, the edge is bringing enough structure to your own process that good ideas actually get finished.

Balanced (learner): You can work with a clear plan or make your own way as the situation calls for it. That range is useful, because some work needs structure and some needs improvisation. As you grow, you can lean on reading which one a given task is asking for.

Facilitator: Reports preference for defined process versus open-ended room. Coaching angle: a structured learner needs clear expectations and advance notice of change, and benefits from practice tolerating ambiguity; an adaptive learner needs room and benefits from light structure to ensure follow-through. Pair with pace, since structured plus methodical especially wants clarity up front.

Contribution mode

Leans Front-facing (learner): You gravitate toward visible roles, being the one who talks to people, presents the work, or is the point of contact. You are comfortable being seen, and that willingness is a real strength, since someone has to be the face and not everyone wants to. As you grow, the edge is making sure the work behind the visibility is as solid as the way you represent it.

Leans Behind the scenes (learner): You gravitate toward building the work itself rather than being the face of it. You would rather make something solid and let it speak than stand in the spotlight. That is a real strength, and the visible stuff falls apart without it. As you grow, the edge is letting yourself be seen and credited for what you make, so your work does not go unnoticed.

Balanced (learner): You can step up front or work behind the scenes depending on what a project needs. That range is valuable, because most work needs both the building and the representing. As you grow, you can choose the role that fits the moment rather than defaulting to one.

Facilitator: Reports preference for visible roles versus behind-the-scenes building. Both essential. Coaching angle: give front-facing learners visible roles but check the substance underneath; make sure behind-the-scenes learners get credit and visibility so they are not overlooked for advancement. Will correlate with some Module 1 archetypes, which is expected. The useful thing to surface is a mismatch, such as a front-facing identity with a behind-the-scenes work style.

Pace

Leans Quick-moving (learner): You tend to move fast, get a version done, and improve from there. You would rather keep things moving than wait for perfect. That momentum is a real strength, especially in work that rewards iteration. As you grow, the edge is knowing which moments call for slowing down and getting it exactly right the first time.

Leans Methodical (learner): You work carefully and thoroughly, getting it right rather than rushing. You would rather take the time than redo it later. That care is a real strength, especially in work where mistakes are costly. As you grow, the edge is knowing when a rough first pass is enough to get moving, since not everything needs to be perfect before it is useful.

Balanced (learner): You can pick up the pace or slow down and be thorough depending on what the work calls for. That range is useful, because some work rewards speed and some rewards care. As you grow, you can read which one a given task is asking for.

Facilitator: Reports work tempo, quick and iterative versus careful and thorough. This is the sustainability dimension. Critical guardrail: a pace mismatch with a track informs support, never exclusion. A methodical learner in a fast track is supported with pacing strategies and early check-ins, not steered away, and a quick-moving learner in a slow, heavily-structured environment can strain too, through boredom and friction. When pace and structure both oppose a track's profile, flag it as higher sustainability risk needing coaching attention before placement, never as a reason to block placement.

Part 5: Module 3, Motivation and Pathway Orientation

What it measures

What keeps the learner engaged, and whether they lean toward placement, ownership, or a blend. Three sub-dimensions, ten items total. Same 5-point Likert scale as Module 1.

The three sub-dimensions

1. Self-direction: how much you want to build, own, and direct your own work.
2. Stability-seeking: how much you want reliable, predictable footing.
3. Risk comfort: how much uncertainty you can sit with. This is the sustainability dimension.

The 10 items

Self-direction

- M3-SDR-01: I feel most invested in work when it is mine to shape and direct.
- M3-SDR-02: The idea of building something of my own appeals to me more than joining something that already exists.
- M3-SDR-03: I want to be responsible for how the whole thing turns out, not just my part of it.

Stability-seeking

- M3-STB-01: Knowing my income is steady matters a lot to me.
- M3-STB-02: I feel more at ease when I know what to expect from one week to the next.
- M3-STB-03: I want work that gives me solid ground to build the rest of my life on.

Risk comfort

- M3-RSK-01: Not knowing exactly how things will turn out does not bother me much.
- M3-RSK-02: If money were not a worry, I would be willing to take a chance on something uncertain.
- M3-RSK-03: When I try something new and get it wrong at first, it doesn't really bother me.
- M3-RSK-04 (reverse-scored): A long stretch of not knowing how things will turn out would wear on me.

Flag M3-RSK-04 in the scoring map as reverse-scored so it is not summed in the wrong direction.

Pathway orientation derivation

Pathway orientation is derived from the pattern, not measured separately. Self-direction and stability-seeking are treated as two independent axes, not as one slider.

- High self-direction, low stability-seeking: ownership lean.
- Low self-direction, high stability-seeking: placement lean.
- High on both: blended. The learner who wants to build something of their own and also needs solid ground.
- Low on both: still exploring. Do not force a pathway. Send to coaching.

Risk comfort modifies sustainability, not direction. A learner high in self-direction but low in risk comfort wants to build but will strain under uncertainty, which means the path needs scaffolding, a safety net, or a staged approach, not redirection.

Circumstance guardrail

Risk comfort and stability-seeking are shaped by material circumstance, not only preference. A learner from a precarious background may have strong ownership drive and simply cannot afford the risk. Two rules belong in the output logic:

1. Items measure desire and energy, not current behavior or resources, so a constrained learner is not scored as risk-averse by nature.
2. Stability-seeking is never a verdict on capacity and never permanent. The output reads as "here is what serves you right now," not "here is who you are."

Do not use the word "entrepreneur" with learners. Use "building your own thing," "ownership," or "running your own work." Both poles are legitimate. Wanting stable footing is not lesser than wanting to build.

Result language

Universal learner framing line: *Module 3 looked at what tends to keep you going and what kind of path might fit you right now. This is about what serves you at this point in your life, not a fixed verdict about who you are or what you are capable of.*

Pathway orientation (learner)

Ownership lean: You are drawn to building and directing your own work. The idea of owning something and shaping how it turns out pulls at you more than slotting into something already built. That drive is a real strength, and it is where a lot of new things come from. A path that gives you room to build and lead, or to grow toward running your own thing, is worth taking seriously. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors can help you find the version of that which fits your life right now.

Placement lean: You are drawn to doing strong work on solid ground. A reliable role where you can contribute and build a stable foundation matters to you more than the pull of running your own thing. That is a real strength, and it is wise, especially when you are building a foundation for the rest of your life. A path that offers a dependable role with room

to grow is worth taking seriously, and Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors can help you find one that fits.

Blended: You want two things at once, to build something of your own and to have solid ground under you. That is one of the most common and most human combinations there is, and it is not a contradiction. It often means the right path lets you build toward ownership in steps, with stability while you do, rather than leaping all at once. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors can help you map what that staged path could look like.

Still exploring: Your answers do not point strongly toward one kind of path yet, and that is completely normal. It often means you are still figuring out what you want, which is exactly the right thing to be doing right now. There is no wrong result here. Beyond Code Collective coaches and instructors can help you try things on and notice what actually pulls at you as you go.

Sustainability note (learner, conditional)

Append only when self-direction is high and risk comfort is low: *One thing worth naming. You are drawn to building your own thing, and you also like knowing where you stand. That usually means the path that lasts for you is a steady, staged one, building toward what you want with support and solid ground along the way, rather than a sudden leap. That is not a smaller version of the goal. For most people it is the wiser route to it.*

Facilitator

Framing: Module 3 reports three motivation drivers and a derived pathway orientation. Read the drivers as what currently serves and energizes the learner, not as fixed traits, and never as a verdict on capacity.

Self-direction: How much the learner wants to build, own, and direct their own work. High suggests roles with autonomy and ownership, or growth toward running their own thing. Low is not lack of ambition; it suggests the learner thrives contributing within a structure someone else holds. Both legitimate.

Stability-seeking: How much the learner wants reliable footing. Read with the circumstance caution: high stability-seeking is often shaped by real material conditions, not temperament. A learner supporting family or carrying debt may have strong ownership drive and simply cannot afford risk. Never treat it as a ceiling on capacity or as permanent.

Risk comfort: How much uncertainty the learner can sit with. The sustainability modifier. High self-direction with low risk comfort signals a learner who wants to build but will strain under sustained uncertainty; the response is scaffolding and a staged path, not redirection away from ownership. Watch the split between wanting the chance (RSK-02) and being able to sit with uncertainty (RSK-01, RSK-03, and reverse-scored RSK-04). Someone who wants the chance but cannot sit with the uncertainty is usually risk-constrained or risk-strained, not low in drive. Coaching angle: build the safety net into the plan.

Pathway orientation: Derived from self-direction and stability-seeking as two independent axes. Ownership lean, placement lean, blended (high on both, the staged-path learner), still

exploring (low on both, do not force a pathway). Use with Modules 1 and 2 for any placement recommendation, and confirm after a coaching conversation. Never use the orientation to gatekeep; it informs the shape of support, not eligibility.

Part 6: Module 4 retired, moved to universal design practice

Module 4, the learning preference read, is retired as an assessment module. The evidence does not support the learning-styles claim that matching instruction to a learner's preferred channel improves learning outcomes. Learners may have real preferences for how they like to receive information, but the stronger claim that teaching to that preference produces better outcomes should not appear in the assessment, learner report, facilitator report, or funder-facing explanation.

The defensible and useful version of that goal is universal design: provide material in multiple forms and build structured peer exchange for every learner, rather than measuring each learner and sorting them by preferred channel. This is not dropping the value of Module 4. It is moving that value to where it belongs: program practice, not individual assessment scoring.

Conceptually, this keeps the framework clean. Modules 1 through 3 measure durable individual differences that can reasonably inform pathway and sustainability decisions: who the learner tends to be, how they tend to work, and what keeps them invested. Learning preference is different. Its most honest use is deciding to offer variety, and the program does not need to measure each person to decide to offer variety.

What replaces it:

- A team commitment to varied resources and structured peer exchange as standard facilitation practice for all learners.
- Self-advocacy as a coaching conversation or one-page handout, helping learners notice what helps them and ask for it, without a scored result.
- A possible facilitator checklist for whether each track offers multiple ways into difficult content.

The eight items freed by retiring Module 4 were reinvested: two into Module 3 risk comfort, four into Module 2, leaving two unspent within the item ceiling.

This decision requires team confirmation because the commitment to deliver varied resources and peer exchange depends on facilitator capacity and real buy-in. It also shifts how the tool is presented to Catalyst and funders: three scored assessment modules, plus a universal design practice layer and a program/partner alignment layer.

Crisp Catalyst framing: the science does not support tailoring instruction to a learning style, so the framework moves that goal into how Catalyst teaches everyone, through varied resources and structured peer exchange, while reinvesting assessment space into the three modules that actually inform pathway and coaching.

Part 7: Open items before programming is finalized

Output language status

- Module 1 archetype language: complete, learner-facing and facilitator-facing.
- Module 2 work-style result language: complete, learner-facing and facilitator-facing, for each axis position.
- Module 3 motivation and pathway result language: complete, learner-facing and facilitator-facing.
- Combined report synthesis and bridging language across the three modules: still to draft. This is the remaining language gap.

Pilot checks to run

- Module 1 inter-archetype correlation, especially among Connector, Support Specialist, Culture Keeper, and Designer. If any pair correlates above roughly 0.70, rewrite or merge.
- Module 2 option balance. If any single option is chosen by more than about 75 percent of learners, the pair is imbalanced and one side reads as the better answer.
- Cross-module correlation, to confirm Modules 1, 2, and 3 are not measuring the same thing in different formats. Specific watch points: Developer item DEV-02 against Systems Thinker, the Explorer items against Module 2 adaptive, contribution mode against Module 1 archetypes, and risk comfort against stability-seeking.
- Module 3 risk comfort split between RSK-01 and RSK-02 and RSK-04, to separate risk-comfortable from risk-constrained.

Professional and team review

- Functional behavioral assessment PhD: item wording, self-report limits, scoring thresholds, confidence bands, interpretation, and cross-module overlap. Send Module 1 items, Module 2 scenarios, and Module 3 items together as one package so cross-module overlap can be checked at once.
- Higher education learning systems PhD: learner experience, implementation, and the facilitation-practice replacement for Module 4.
- Catalyst team: the move to three dimensions, the facilitation-practice commitment, the alignment layer, placement review workflow, and data privacy and consent.

Still to define

- Combined report synthesis and bridging language, the remaining output-language gap noted above.
- Privacy, consent, data retention, and role-based access.
- Pilot size, feedback collection, and claims the team can make after pilot.

- Program and partner track alignment layer, and the monthly refresh workflow.